

NAVIGATION TOOLS

Sailors exploring new territories had no maps to guide them, so they had to find their way by other methods. Navigators used a compass to find the right direction, and they calculated their position by observing stars and planets.



MAGNETIC COMPASS
18th century, Italy.



ASTROLABE
Allowed sailors to use the stars to navigate.



LODESTONE
The earliest type of magnetic compass.



GLOBE
For calculating routes and bearings.



TELESCOPE
Used to identify landmarks from a distance.



EARLY AIRCRAFT INSTRUMENT PANEL
Showed aircraft's height and speed.

SCIENTIFIC JOURNEYS

In the 19th century, the thirst for knowledge was so great that scientists and naturalists such as Charles Darwin embarked on long and dangerous trips to search out new species of animals or plants.



MICROSCOPE
Used by Charles Darwin in the 1830s.



INSECT DRAWINGS
Sketched by naturalist Henry Bates.



BEETLE SPECIMENS
Collected by Charles Darwin.



SNOUTFISH
Collected by explorer Mary Kingsley.

ADVENTURERS OF THE GOLDEN AGE

Exploration was a risky business, but the rewards were potentially huge. Successful explorers could expect fame, wealth, and personal favours from a grateful monarch.

- **CHRISTOPHER COLUMBUS (1451–1506)** Italian sailor Columbus was paid by King Ferdinand and Queen Isabella of Spain to find a sea route to China. Instead, in 1492, he found America and called it the New World.



VASCO DA GAMA

- **VASCO DA GAMA (c.1460–1524)** A Portuguese explorer, he led the first expedition to sail round the Cape of Good Hope, at the tip of Africa, to India.

- **FERDINAND MAGELLAN (1480–1521)** Magellan led the first expedition to sail all the way round the world. Unfortunately, Magellan himself did not make it home alive: he was killed in a battle between local tribes in the Philippines.



FERDINAND MAGELLAN

- **HERNAN CORTES (1485–1541)** A Spanish conquistador (soldier), Cortés first travelled to Mexico to set up a trading colony for Spain, but ended up destroying the entire Aztec Empire in Central America.

- **SIR WALTER RALEIGH (c.1552–1618)** An English adventurer who tried unsuccessfully to set up colonies in the New World, but who is best remembered for bringing tobacco back to Europe from the Americas.



SIR WALTER RALEIGH



POLAR PIONEERS

In the 19th century, the cold, hostile regions of the Arctic and Antarctic were largely undiscovered. Explorers from many different countries joined the race to be the first to conquer the North and South poles.



INUIT (ESKIMO) KNIVES WITH BONE HANDLE
Made of steel from the abandoned ship of Sir John Franklin, who failed to find a sea route through the Arctic Ocean, north of Canada.



WINDPROOF HOOD
Worn by Sir Ernest Shackleton on his South Pole attempt of 1907-08.



CLASP KNIFE AND SEXTANT
Used by Captain Robert Scott on his South Pole expedition of 1912.



CROSS-COUNTRY SKIS
Used by Captain Scott in his first South Pole expedition, 1901-04.



POLAR SLEDGE
Eight-man sledge from an Arctic expedition in 1875.